



Apple dreams big!

Apple forecasts that it will ship over 100 million iPhone 12 units in 2020. <https://dgit.in/dec19-01>



Huawei also dreams big...?

Huawei founder, Ren Zhengfei, thinks they can be the number one smartphone brand despite Google ban. <https://dgit.in/dec19-02>



The Silent Podcast

Agent001 helps a friend start a podcast

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ne of the things that's been creeping its way into mainstream popularity has been podcasts. Practically

every major service provider has launched a podcast service over the course of these past two years, and of those services most have already made their way into India. So, it was no surprise when one of my pals decided that he was going to start his own podcast and asked for my help to set up the equipment for him to get started. I'm not going to bore you guys about all the things that he's going to be basing his podcast around except that he wasn't going to be starting any time soon. That's because he bought an XLR microphone to record his voice but couldn't figure out why the microphone wasn't working with his PC. Before you guys jump to conclusions, let me tell you that he did get an XLR to 3.5 mm plug which allowed him to plug the microphone into the PC. The problem was the power.

A good majority of the semi-pro and pro-audio microphones are rated to work at 48 volts. Your average PC can't handle that. For these microphones, you need something that can provide the power and seek the input as well. This "something" is called an audio interface. They feature XLR inputs with 48 volts phantom power, so you can plug in the professional grade microphones as well as the cheaper ones that don't need the

additional phantom power source. The phantom power is needed for condenser microphones that have a little active circuitry (preamp) inside them and also have a transducer element that needs to be polarised. Without phantom power, the microphone will find it extremely difficult to pick up audio. So the budding podcaster was now in need of an audio interface with 48v phantom power and a couple of other devices to make the entire production pipeline easier.

Dante which transport audio over IP with low latency. These are usually seen in more professional setups and increase the cost significantly since you'd have to invest in an entire ecosystem that uses the same interconnect. Then comes the price. With more features, you must shell out more money. This was also an aspect for consideration.

Since we were looking at the entry segment for audio interfaces with USB ports, the search was narrowed down



Behringer U-Phoria UMC204HD

Audio interfaces comes in many shapes and sizes and have a myriad of features that may or may not be of use to you. The input options, output options, on device filters, monitor output, and included software are just some of the things off the top of my head that would warrant consideration. Since my friend was just starting out with podcasts, he would only need an interface with one XLR input and perhaps another one should he choose to have guests and need a double microphone setup. Audio interfaces also come with proprietary interconnects such as RedNet, AVB and

by quite a bit. While a lot of brands do service this niche, we don't get all of them in India. Popular ecommerce stores such as Amazon and Flipkart do have a few but there are these pro-audio stores who stock practically every brand selling in India. Of these, we found Focusrite, Audient, Behringer, M-Audio, Vault, PreSonus and Zoom to have good audio interfaces for the budget oriented folks. ProSonus has a pretty good package called the 96 Studio High Definition Recording Kit that comes with everything in the box (interface, cables, software, headset,